

VOLUNTARY ACKNOWLEDGMENT OF RISK & GROUP TRIP AGREEMENT

IMPORTANT NOTICE: BY AGREEING TO THIS DOCUMENT, YOU ARE WAIVING CERTAIN LEGAL RIGHTS INCLUDING THE RIGHT TO SUE FOR INJURIES OR PROPERTY DAMAGE SUSTAINED DURING OUTINGS. PLEASE READ CAREFULLY.

Document Version: 2026-07 | Scope: All Overland East Bay Group Outings

1. Express Assumption of Backcountry Risks

I understand and acknowledge that overlanding, off-roading, and remote camping are inherently dangerous activities. I am voluntarily participating in this trip with full knowledge of the risks involved, including rough terrain, vehicle instability, rollover, environmental hazards, and delayed medical emergency response times.

I explicitly assume all risks -- both known and unknown -- associated with this trip, including property damage, severe personal injury, or death.

2. Vehicle Damage & 'Fix Your Own Rig' Policy

Self-Responsibility: I agree that I am solely financially responsible for my own vehicle, equipment, and personal belongings.

Spotting and Recovery: If another Participant assists me by spotting, navigating, winching, or recovering my vehicle, I accept that they do so as a casual courtesy.

Release of Liability: I release all other Participants from liability for property damage to my vehicle or gear, even if caused by ordinary negligence.

3. Remote Recovery & Towing Costs

Vehicle recovery in remote areas (BLM land or National Forests) can be exceptionally expensive.

If a mechanical breakdown occurs, the group will make reasonable safe efforts to assist.

If professional off-road recovery or transport is required, I assume 100% of the financial burden for my vehicle.

4. Medical Emergencies & Evacuation Expenses

In the event of a medical emergency where I cannot communicate, I authorize my Trip Mates to contact Search and Rescue (SAR) or emergency evacuation (including life-flight).

I agree to be solely responsible for all financial costs associated with my medical care or evacuation.

5. Driving and Vehicle Operation

I certify that I hold a valid driver's license and automotive insurance satisfying State of California minimum liability requirements.

Vehicle Swapping: If I drive another participant's vehicle or allow another to drive mine, any resulting claims are handled directly between those specific parties.

6. California Law and Severability

This Agreement is governed by the laws of California. It covers claims of ordinary negligence but does not waive claims from gross negligence or intentional misconduct.